

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey • 65,437 respondents • 180+ countries

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Employment status mix (global) vs. full-time trend (U.S.)

Global status (of respondents): Working 84% • Full-time 69% • Freelance 16.4% • Student 13%

Full-time 69%

Freelance 16.4%

Student 13%

United States: Full-time employment

2023 69.0%

2024 64.8%

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

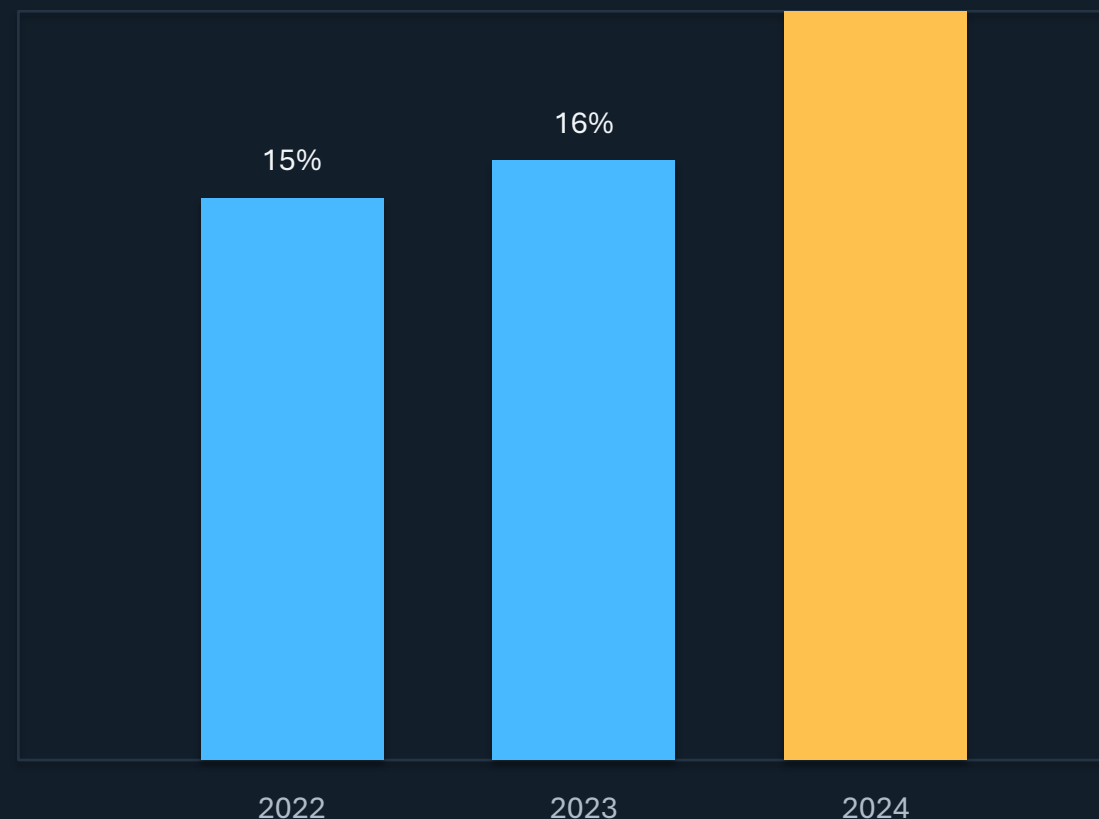
Work environment (2022–2024): hybrid vs. remote vs. in-person

Hybrid remains the most common: 42%
(consistent with 2023)

Remote work: 38%

In-person rising for the third consecutive year:
15% → 16% → 20%

In-person work share



In-person trend: 15% (2022), 16% (2023), 20% (2024)

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

Median annual compensation (USD). 22,677 salary responses (34.7% response rate).

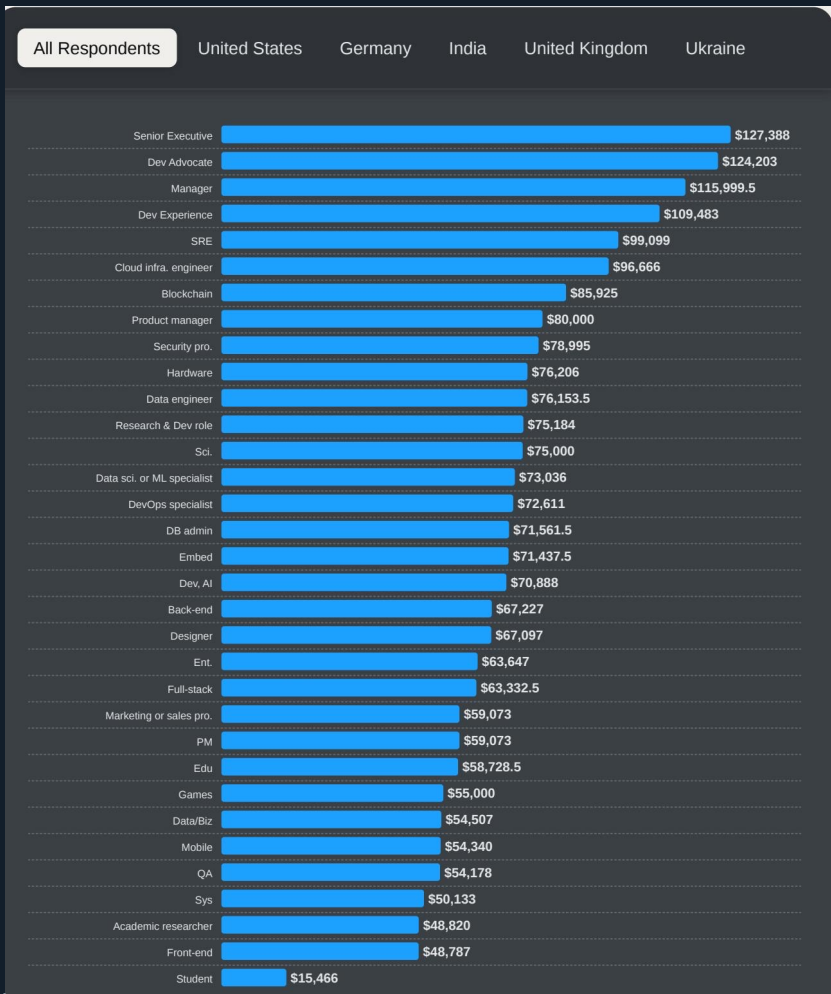
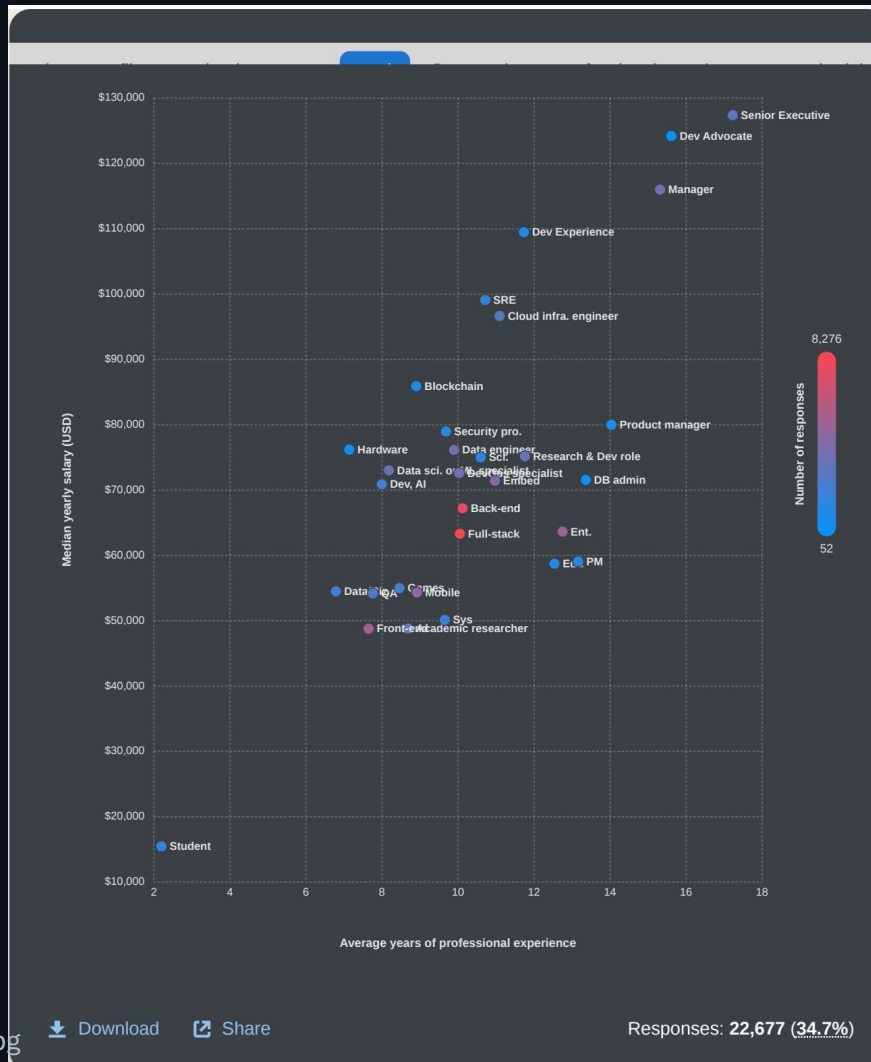


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Senior Executive: \$127,388
Dev Advocate: \$124,203
Manager: \$115,999
Dev Experience: \$109,483
SRE: \$99,099
Cloud Infra. Engineer: \$96,666
Blockchain: \$85,925
Product Manager: \$80,000
Full-stack: \$63,333
Front-end: \$48,787

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

Median salary (y) vs. avg. years experience (x) by developer type



Upper-right cluster: Senior Executive, Dev Advocate, Manager

High-paid technical roles: SRE and Cloud Infra Engineer

Outlier: Student — \$15,466 median salary, ~2 years experience

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Median salary vs. avg. experience by language. Salary range ~('\$60–75K USD', '\$70–85K USD').

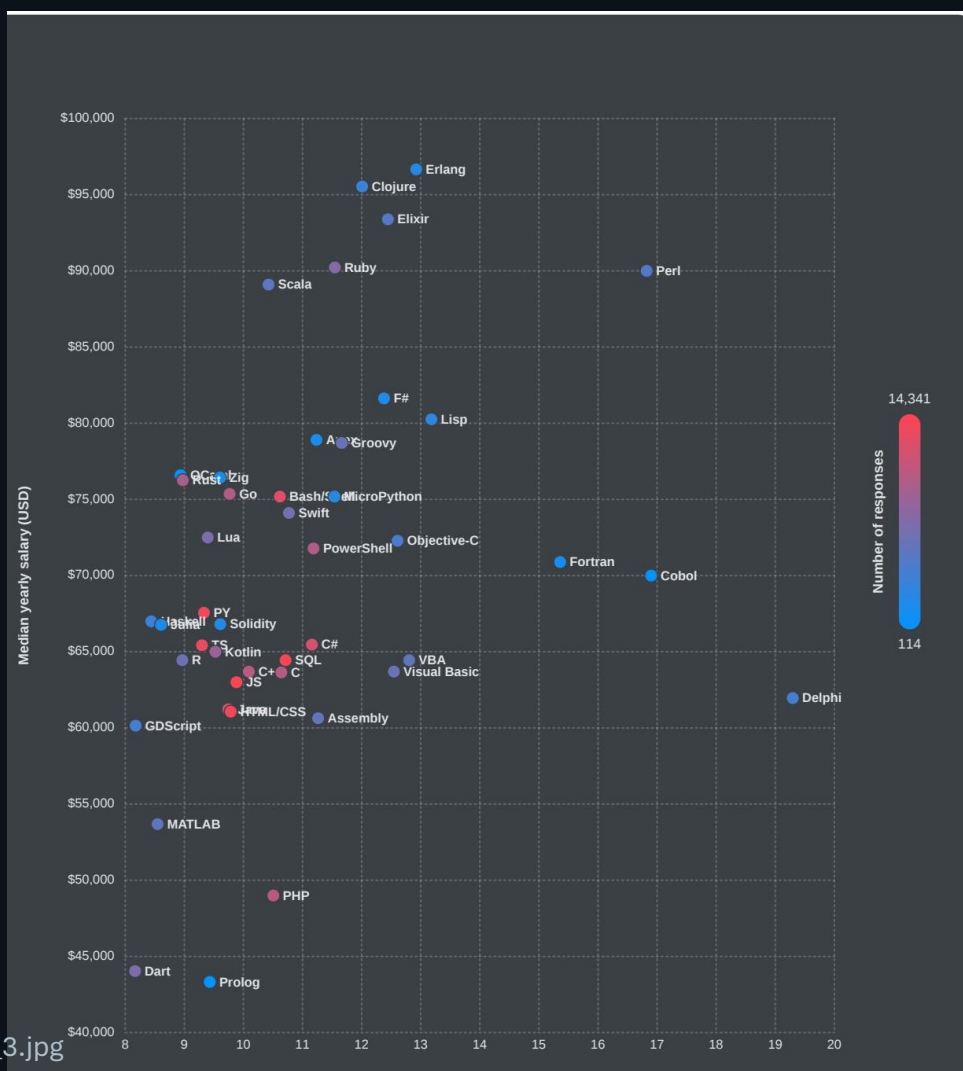


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Top earners: Erlang (~\$97,000), Clojure (~\$95,000), Elixir (~\$93,000)

Lowest: Dart (~\$44,000), Prolog (~\$43,000), PHP (~\$49,000)

High experience outlier: Perl (~19 years, ~\$90,000)

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Organization context + developer influence on tooling decisions

Company size distribution (42,827 respondents)

Freelancer / solo: 6.1%

2–9 employees: 10.4%

10–19 employees: 8.9%

20–99 employees: 21.2%

100–499 employees: 18.5%

500–999 employees: 6.7%

1,000–4,999 employees: 11.0%

5,000–9,999 employees: 3.8%

10,000+ employees: 11.4%

62% influence technology purchases

Highest influence roles: Senior executives (99%), Engineering managers (87%), Product managers (77%)

60% prefer a build-and-buy approach

Top evaluation methods: Start a free trial (75%); Ask other developers (73%)

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

Actionable implications for compensation benchmarking and workforce planning

Plan for mix shifts: U.S. full-time employment fell from 69% (2023) to 64.8% (2024); freelancing remains 16.4% globally

Design for the real workplace: in-person rose to 20% (up from 15% in 2022), but hybrid still leads at 42%

Benchmark premiums: Senior Executive (\$127,388), Dev Advocate (\$124,203), and Manager (\$115,999) lead median pay; SRE (\$99,099) and Cloud Infra Engineer (\$96,666) top technical roles

Treat language stacks as a pay signal: niche functional languages (Erlang/Clojure/Elixir) show >\$93K medians while Dart/Prolog sit below \$45K

Engage developers in retention and tooling: 62% influence tech purchases; most prefer build-and-buy (60%) and evaluate via trials (75%) and peer input (73%)